ANSWER KEY

QP CODE:25900580

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025

THIRD SEMESTER

Value Addition Course (VAC) -MG3VACPJM200, MG3VACPOL200 -

SECULARISM AND CULTURAL DIVERSITY

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

PART A

1. b). Keshab Chandra Sen

2. d). All of the above

3. c). Article 29

4. a) Section 377

5. c). Adi Granth

6. c). Division of the nation on religious lines

7. b). Public Funding of Religious Rituals

8. a). Triple Talaq legislation

9. c). Allows state intervention

10. c). 1986

PART B

11.Treaty of Westphalia (1648) marked the beginning of the modern nation-state system by establishing state sovereignty, legal equality among states, and non-interference in internal affairs, shaping international relations and political order.

12. Bharatanatyam evolved from ancient Tamil Nadu temple traditions, particularly from the Devadasi system-transformed into a classical dance emphasizing rhythm, expression, and spirituality, revived in the 20th century as a symbol of Indian cultural heritage-Kuchipudi is a classical dance form from Andhra Pradesh combining graceful movements, expressive storytelling, and rhythmic footwork rooted in ancient Sanskrit theatre traditions.

13. Judiciary safeguards secularism through judgments ensuring equality of all religions, banning discrimination, and limiting state support for religious practices-upholds constitutional principles of freedom of religion and separation of state and faith.

14. Reservation policies have empowered Dalits by ensuring representation in education, employment, and politics-aim to correct historical injustices, promote social inclusion, and enhance equality within India's democratic framework of affirmative action.

15. Secularism means separation of religion and state, ensuring religious freedom and equality-promotes tolerance, protects minority rights, and maintains neutrality of the state in religious matters to preserve harmony in a plural society.

16. Gupta Empire's golden age saw advances in art, literature, science, and mathematics-achievements included works by Kalidasa, Aryabhata's discoveries, and flourishing architecture, marking a peak in India's classical cultural development.

17. Fake news spreads misinformation that provokes communal tensions and distrust among religious groups-fuels prejudice, distorts facts, and undermines social harmony, leading to polarization and potential outbreaks of violence in diverse societies.

18. Mandir–Masjid dispute reshaped Indian party politics by mobilizing religious sentiment-eventual destruction of Babari Masjid-intensified communal polarization, influenced electoral strategies, and strengthened Hindu nationalist narratives, transforming secular political discourse into identity-based competition.

PART C

19. Nehruvian secularism emphasized a modern, scientific outlook and strict separation of religion from politics, promoting equal state distance from all faith-Gandhian secularism valued moral and spiritual unity, viewing all religions as paths to truth and emphasizing tolerance, harmony, and mutual respect rather than separation.

20. Personal laws preserve religious and cultural identity by allowing communities to follow their own traditions in matters like marriage, inheritance, and family- protect diversity and autonomy but also face criticism for perpetuating inequality, especially concerning gender rights and uniformity in national legal frameworks.

21. Regional political parties safeguard linguistic identity by promoting regional languages, culture, and interests within federal politics- advocate for language-based education, local autonomy, and equitable resource distribution, ensuring that India's linguistic diversity is respected and represented in governance and policy decisions.

22.Abrogation of Article 370 in 2019 aimed to integrate Jammu and Kashmir fully into India, promoting uniform laws and governance-supporters see it as national consolidation, while critics argue it deepened alienation, reduced autonomy, and heightened political and social tensions in the region.